HUMAN RESOURCES · SEPARATION DOCUMENTATION

Exit Interview Record

Hamza Siddique · Coach, NIETE · Interviewed by **Tahir Saleem** · 7 October 2026

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DURATION	SEPARATION	SECTOR	INTERVIEW DATE
53 Min	Voluntary	Tarnol	7 Oct

1 Employee Details

Employee Name	Hamza Siddique — hamza.siddique@niete.edu.pk
Designation	Coach, NIETE — Tarnol sector
Length of Service	Not stated in the interview — to be confirmed from records
Interview Date & Mode	7 October 2026 — recorded video call (53 minutes)
Type of Separation	Voluntary resignation

2 Reasons for Leaving

He said his overall experience had been positive with good growth, and that the decision came down to "multiple things." These are the drivers as he gave them.

- He described the environment as **"suffocating"** — micro-management, favouritism and a team climate in which raising a concern was not safe.
- The **"Taleemabad vs NIETE" dichotomy** — from day one he felt leadership claimed one organisation while NIETE staff were treated differently and more harshly.
- **Loss of trust in HR** following a pay and experience-verification dispute he says was mishandled over roughly ten months and never resolved.
- He said other people had already left the team, and in his view that reflects the environment rather than coincidence.

3 What He Said Worked

- **His own growth.** He opened by saying his overall experience had been positive and that he had grown in the role.
- **Admin team.** Praised as helpful and responsive.
- **The earlier culture of trust.** Asked what he admired most, he pointed to the period under **Waqas Tanveer**, when a work-from-home arrangement for coaches after field visits was trialled. He described it as a time of genuine trust in which people performed well and felt admired rather than scrutinised, and said it was not abused.
- **The team as it used to be.** He said the team dynamic was stronger and more connected before the recent turnover.

4 What He Flagged

4.1 — The Taleemabad / NIETE two-tier system. His central point. He said leadership claims a single organisation while the practical treatment differs: NIETE staff pay for meals where others do not, and policies change for NIETE staff while remaining stable for Taleemabad staff. He also said that where an operational failure arose, the response was to abolish the policy — for example leave — rather than fix the problem. He said this inconsistency, and the absence of a stated justification for it, is what created the underlying distrust.

4.2 — Micro-management and authority without a reason. He described strict **8 AM office attendance** enforced through the 50-day summer period when coaches were not in the field. He argued no field work was being missed, no alternative such as compensating time was offered, and no reason was given. He said latecomers were **marked in red and named in group chats**. He quoted his manager, **Abdul Waheed**, as justifying it with *"just because I am manager, I can force you."* He contrasted this with Taleemabad staff working core hours remotely without the same scrutiny, and asked why the same trust could not be extended.

4.3 — A team climate in which people stay silent. He described the Tarnol team as divided between a "yes boss" group and those on the sidelines, and said that if someone outside the inner circle had a problem, others would not even ask about it. He gave a specific incident: in a team meeting he challenged the manager on the definition of flexible hours, reminding him of a past commitment. **The manager denied having said it, and the team stayed silent.** One colleague, **Saman**, then quoted the manager's exact earlier words and corroborated him. He expected the team to discuss it afterwards; instead it was dropped as though it had not happened. He described this as the moment that confirmed his view of the culture.

4.4 — Favouritism stated openly. He said favouritism was not merely practised but advocated, and quoted **Abdul Waheed** as saying *"I do favouritism. I am a favourite."* He named **Imran**, and to some extent **Sana**, as receiving privileges such as easier leave. He was explicit that he was **not questioning their work** — his objection was to the principle. He argued that favouring someone for exceeding the requirement, for example doing 20 observations where 15 are required, deprives others of their entitlement and sets burnout-level output as the price of fair treatment. His own approach — meet the requirement, with quality — put him outside the manager's criteria.

4.5 — The HR pay and verification dispute. His most detailed complaint, and the one he returned to. It concerns an experience-verification matter affecting his pay, dating from **December 2023** and running roughly ten months.

- He sent emails and tagged HR, and received no reply.
- He was assured by **Ayesha**, **Jawwad** and **Zeshan** that it would be settled at appraisal. It was not.
- The reason he was eventually given was that verification had failed because the previous employer did not respond to an email. **He disputes this** — he says that email was never sent to the official contact he had provided. (One account records that it went to a personal Gmail address rather than the official contact.)
- He produced a **screenshot of a Teams message from a colleague at his former organisation** confirming the verification had in fact been completed.
- He said HR "twisted" the definition of verification to cover the inaction, and used the word **"lying"**.
- He eventually dropped the case out of frustration — he says particularly after seeing others compensated.

> **Restricted.** Section 4.5 names individual HR staff and includes an allegation of dishonesty. It should be handled by HR / People & Culture leadership and not circulated with the rest of this record.

4.6 — Training does not leave coaches with anything verifiable. He said the organisation provides no formal, internationally recognised training, and that coaching work amounts largely to revision work. The result is that coaches leave with **no certification or verifiable skill**, which limits their careers and, he argued, the organisation's own capability.

4.7 — Manipulation rather than facilitation. He said coaches were managed with excuses he considered baseless — he gave the example of government pressure being cited as the reason for refusing leave — and asked for facilitation and trust in place of this.

5 Individuals He Named

NAME	CONTEXT	WHAT HE SAID	REF
Abdul Waheed (his manager)	ADVERSE	The subject of 4.2, 4.3 and 4.4 — the 8 AM mandate and "just because I am manager", the denial of his earlier commitment in the team meeting, and the statement about practising favouritism.	4.2–4.4
Imran, **Sana**	MENTIONED	Named as receiving favourable treatment such as easier leave. He stated explicitly that he was not questioning their work — his objection was to the principle.	4.4
Ayesha, **Jawwad**, **Zeshan**	ADVERSE	Named as the HR personnel who assured him the pay dispute would be settled at appraisal. It was not.	4.5
Saman	POSITIVE	The one colleague who spoke up in the meeting and quoted the manager's earlier words, corroborating him.	4.3
Waqas Tanveer	POSITIVE	Named for the earlier period of trust and the work-from-home trial, which he described as what he admired most.	3

> **Note on the adverse mentions.** These are one person's account, unverified, and the individuals named have not been given any opportunity to respond. Names, quotes and the sequence of the meeting incident should be checked against the recording before being repeated or acted on. This document records what was said; it does not establish that it is correct.

6 What He Asked For

Recorded as he put them — these are his own recommendations, not additions made afterwards.

- **Align the claim with the practice.** His closing point: if NIETE coaches are Taleemabad employees, treat them exactly as Taleemabad employees in Islamabad are treated. If they are not, then say so plainly and separate the structures, so people know which rules apply to them. The present middle ground is what causes the resentment.
- **Regular anonymous feedback on managers** — monthly or bi-monthly, covering manager behaviour, micro-management and facilitation. This was his main structural proposal: a check on managerial power from the people it is exercised on.
- **Collective values, practised across all sectors** — not values that change depending on who the manager is.
- **Real training and certification for coaches** — legitimate, internationally recognised credentials (he gave the World Bank as an example), so coaches leave with verifiable skills.
- **Leadership should use the organisation's own products**, to set the example and to be able to give authentic feedback on them.
- **Re-establish trust-based working** — revisit the work-from-home arrangement and modern working models, rather than defaulting to scrutiny.
- **Facilitation instead of manipulation** — stop managing coaches with excuses that cannot be justified.

Tahir Saleem